

● **AI Safe@Work**

INTERNAL · V2026.05

Market sizing.

Who can buy this course, how many of them exist, how many we can realistically win, and what that's worth.

Owner Founder **Effective** 2026-05-19 **Review** quarterly **Status** v1 baseline

AISAFEATWORK.ORG · GITHUB.COM/AFRHUB/AI-SAFE-AT-WORK

EU AI ACT

GDPR

ISO 42001

ISO 27001

The numbers, in one breath.

- **Total addressable market** (any AI-using employer globally): ~10M orgs — not useful to monetise.
- **Serviceable addressable market** (EU+UK SMB/mid-market that touches AI for work, regulated reach): **~2.5M orgs**.
- **Serviceable obtainable (3-year): 1,500–3,000 paying orgs + 5,000–10,000 paying individuals.**
- **Y3 ARR — realistic:** £250k–£600k self-sustaining · £1–3M with paid marketing or partnership.
- **Y5 ceiling** with Qualiopi + accreditation + sector overlays: **£8–15M ARR.**

Market is real, large, and underserved on the wedge. Bottleneck is founder-time + procurement-readiness gates, not demand.

TAM · SAM · SOM at-a-glance

LAYER	DEFINITION	SIZE 2026	REVENUE CEILING
TAM	Every org globally that uses AI w/ staff = a "deployer"	~10M orgs (EU+UK+US+CA+AU/NZ commercial, rough)	not meaningfully monetisable as one number
SAM	EU+UK SMB + mid-market that touches AI and is in any regulator's reach	~2.5M orgs	~£500M/yr at Starter price (impossible to win all)
SOM Y1–3	What we can realistically win	1,500–3,000 orgs at 18mo · 5,000–8,000 at 36mo	£450k–£2.4M/yr ARR
SOM Y5	w/ Qualiopi + CPD-accreditation + OPCO + sector overlays	~20,000 orgs + ~50,000 individual seats/yr	£8–15M/yr ARR

TAM — universe of deployers

POOL	SOURCE	COUNT
EU-27 SMBs (≤250 staff)	Eurostat 2024 SBA Fact Sheets	~ 25M orgs · ~100M employees
UK SMBs	UK gov Business Population Estimates 2024	~ 5.5M orgs · ~16M employees
EU-27 enterprises (≥10 staff) using AI 2023	Eurostat ICT in enterprises 2023	~8% of large enterprises (rising fast)
EU enterprises with any AI use including shadow	McKinsey + IDC surveys 2024 (informal)	~ 50–70% by 2026
US small business	SBA 2024	~33M orgs · ~6.4M with employees

EU AI Act Article 4 applies to every employer with ≥1 employee using AI. Binding from 2 February 2025. No size threshold. Realistic universe needing training: **2–4 million orgs in EU+UK alone by end of 2026.**

SAM — who matches our wedge

Doctrine wedge: non-tech SMB staff · EU-first · plain English · standards-cited · free core + paid operational layer.

FILTER	POOL	DROPS
EU+UK SMBs	30.5M	starting universe
– Solo traders (no employees)	–22M	~8.5M
– No AI use yet (genuinely)	–30–40%	~5M
– Too small to procure any training (1–2 staff)	–2M	~3M
– Already covered by big-vendor LMS (MS/Google)	–500k	~2.5M
SAM		~2.5M orgs

Mostly: 5–200 staff service businesses · consultancies · agencies · accountants · lawyers · designers · marketing · light industrial · retail · hospitality · education · healthcare practices · public sector small bodies ·

local government. Already pay for some compliance/training stack OR genuinely have nothing yet.

SOM — where to land first (by sector)

SECTOR	WHY THEY BUY FAST	POOL (EU+UK)	3-YR WIN RATE	ORGS WON
Professional services — accountants, lawyers, consultancies	Personal liability from AI hallucination; bar/SRA/ICAEW warnings; clients ask	~600k	0.5–1%	3,000–6,000
Financial services SMB — independent advisers, brokers, fintech ≤50 staff	DORA Art 13 training mandatory Jan 2025; FCA equivalent in UK	~80k	1–2%	800–1,600
Healthcare SMB — clinics, dental, vet, allied health, telehealth	HIPAA / EU MDR + AI Act overlap; named-patient risk; insurance pressure	~200k	0.5–1%	1,000–2,000
Public sector small bodies — councils, NHS trusts, schools, NDPBs	UK AI Playbook; FRIA mandatory under AI Act Art 27	~50k	1–3%	500–1,500
Education — independent schools, MATs, FE, HEIs	DfE AI guidance; teacher union pressure; safeguarding overlap	~70k	1–2%	700–1,400
Marketing / agencies — PR, content, design, dev shops	Daily AI use; client IP + GDPR exposure; pitching credentials	~300k	0.3–0.7%	900–2,100
HR-heavy SMBs + recruitment agencies	EU AI Act Annex III high-risk; NYC LL144 (US clients); bias-audit	~150k	0.5–1%	750–1,500
Insurance SMB + brokers	NAIC Model Bulletin; Colorado SB21-169; EIOPA pressure	~30k	1–2%	300–600
All other compliance-conscious SMB	General GDPR + ISO 27001 + EU AI Act Art 4	~1.1M	0.05–0.15%	550–1,650

Realistic 3-year SOM = 8,500–18,000 orgs paying.

Phase 1 launch-slice avg deal (60% Starter £299 + 30% Business £999 + 10% Enterprise £3,999) = **£737 / org / yr.**

→ ceiling £6.3M–£13.3M ARR. Real conversion much slower in years 1–3 — expect ~20–30% of ceiling.

SOM — by geography

geography	pool (smb)	wedge fit	notes
France	4.2M	High	OPCO funding unlocks at Qualiopi cert. Sister project win2linux pipeline reusable.
Germany	3.4M	High	BSI-aligned ISO 27001 culture; Mittelstand procurement loves audit-pack.
UK	5.5M	High	Post-Brexit ICO + DSIT push; lower price-resistance than EU average.
Italy / Spain / NL / Belgium	combined ~8M	Medium	Need language; reachable once FR + DE first wave succeeds.
Nordics (DK/SE/NO/FI/IS)	combined ~1.5M	Medium-high	High procurement maturity; English-tolerant; pay well.
Ireland	280k	High	English-language EU; tech-hub spillover; GDPR pressure.
CEE + Baltics	combined ~2.5M	Low-medium	Price-sensitive; OPCO equivalent rare.
US	6.4M w/ employees	Medium	Different regulator stack (NIST, NYDFS, state AI laws); needs US-specific overlay first.
Aus / NZ / CA	combined ~1.5M	Low at launch	Language ✓; ICO-equivalent maturity ✓; lower priority until EU saturated.

Buyer-persona shortlist

PERSONA	TITLE	PAIN	TRIGGER TO BUY
Compliance-burdened owner-operator	MD / Founder of 10–50 staff SMB	"I don't even know if we're compliant; one customer asked us last week."	Customer questionnaire arrives, RFP rejection, ICO letter, news of a public breach
HR / People Ops lead	Head of People at 50–200 staff	"Staff use ChatGPT for performance reviews and I don't know how to handle this."	Manager surfaces an incident, new joiner asks for AUP, annual ISO 27001 audit looming
DPO / compliance officer	DPO at 100–500 staff	"EU AI Act Art 4 is binding and I have nothing on paper."	Board asks "are we doing anything", DPA reissue from a vendor, peer-org breach
IT director	IT Director at 50–300 staff	"I need an LMS payload for the SCORM-capable system we already pay for."	Procurement asks "what's our AI training plan", SCORM-vendor renewal
Public-sector procurement	Procurement / IG officer at council / NHS trust	"Framework requires AI literacy evidence."	Tender for an AI tool, framework re-let, audit
HE/FE compliance lead	Director of compliance at university	"Students + staff using AI; we need both training and policy."	New term, regulator letter, JISC guidance update
Individual learner — solo consultant	Freelance compliance / GDPR consultant	"I need a cheap cert for LinkedIn while I work toward AIGP."	Procurement asks for credentials, contract negotiation

Conversion funnel — realistic 3-year ramp

Assumptions: SEO + free-core word-of-mouth as primary acquisition; minimal paid spend; founder time as the main constraint.

STAGE	Y1 (LAUNCH)	Y2 (COMPOUNDING)	Y3 (PROCUREMENT-WINNING)
Monthly free-tier visits	3,000	25,000	80,000
% converting to free-cert hold	8%	12%	15%
Free-cert holds / mo	240	3,000	12,000
% escalating to Pro Cert £49	1%	2%	3%
Individual paid sales / mo	~2–3	~60	~360
Enterprise leads / mo	1–2	8–12	30–50
Enterprise close rate	15%	25%	35%
New Enterprise customers / mo	~0.2	~3	~15
Cumulative paying enterprise @ EoY	3	35	170
Cumulative paying individual @ EoY	30	750	5,000
ARR @ EoY (no paid mktg)	~£2.7k	~£44k	~£245k
ARR w/ paid mktg + 1 partnership	n/a	~£80k	£450k–£800k

Big assumptions / risks

ASSUMPTION	IF WRONG, WHAT BREAKS
EU AI Act Art 4 enforcement creates buyer-side pressure by Q3 2026	Slow market; conversion drops 50%+
SEO + free-core word-of-mouth produces meaningful organic traffic without paid mktg	Need paid acquisition budget; margin compresses
Competitors (IAPP / KnowBe4 / Microsoft) don't launch sub-£10/seat AI module in 12mo	Price compression; lean harder on EU + SMB specificity
Founder can sustain solo through Y1 to Y2 ramp	Bus factor #1 risk in doctrine — kills everything
Buyers will pay for operational layer when content is free	Need ~25% free→paid conversion; if 5%, math collapses
Procurement accepts "self-assessed" Standards Map without external attestation	Need to subcontract attestation faster; cost rises ~£3k/yr per major buyer

One-line answer

Realistic addressable market: 2.5M EU+UK SMBs that touch AI for work.

Realistic 3-year win: 1,500–3,000 paying orgs + 5,000–10,000 paying individuals.

Realistic Y3 ARR: £250k–£600k self-sustaining · £1–3M with paid marketing or partnership.

Y5 ceiling w/ Qualiopi + accreditation + sector overlays: £8–15M ARR.

Demand is not the constraint. Procurement-readiness gates + founder time are.

Sources: Eurostat 2024 SBA Fact Sheets · UK Business Population Estimates 2024 · Eurostat ICT in enterprises 2023 · US SBA 2024 · McKinsey + IDC AI adoption surveys 2024.
Re-walked: each quarterly cycle per `.audit/course-quality/refresh-cadence.md`.
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